London Borough of Camden
Information and Records Management
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Date: 11/06/2024
Ref: CAM7230

Dear Requester

Thank you for your request for information dated 05/03/2024 about Central Heating failure on the Curnock Street Estate. We have dealt with this under the Environmental Information Regulations 2004.

Response

The council holds the information requested.

Central Heating failure on the Curnock Street Estate

Last December and as recently as last weekend, the Central Heating system failed to provide heating (December) or Hot Water (Feb-Mar 2024). I would like to know the following:

1. The exact ALL reasons for the failures. Be as technical as you can possibly be.
There is an issue with the hot water recovery rate during peak demands. Coupled with the BMS strategy implemented by third-party contractors, the system modulates based on outside air temperatures averaged over 8 hours. This produces a long lag period when there is a high demand on the system, affecting hot water recovery rates even further.

2. What are the exact repairs/works you did to restore the service? Did you use any spare parts, chemicals, etc, and what was the cost for those things plus the extra labour hours outside of the GEM contract?
An additional 300KW's of hot water plate heat exchangers were installed to provide increased heat transfer from primary to secondary hot water system.

3. Reasons for taking so long to restore the service every time there is a failure. Eight days it took during the last instance to restore the service.
Clarified:
Please find some clarifications on this link: https://curnockstreetestate.com/2024/02/28/no-hot-water-for-many-days/
The whole estate was complaining but some of the references are:
3474214/1
3474599/1
3474601/1
3474602/1
3474606/1
3474607/1
3474608/1
3474610/1

3474611/1
3474612/1
3474613/1
3474614/1
3474615/1
The system was not offline for 8 days, there is an issue with recovery rate of hot water in peak demands, coupled with the BMS strategy implemented by 3rd party contractors the system modulates based on outside air temperatures average over 8 hours. This produces a long lag period for when there is a high demand on the system, affecting hot water recovery rates even further.

4. How many complaints did you receive during those failures? How many of them you have upheld?
- 3 complaints.
- 3 upheld.

5. How many compensations did you give and how much per compensation?
£0. Compensation is payable for service interruptions greater than three days. Guidance below:
Heating repairs - Camden Council

6. What steps, if any, are the council and/or GEM taking to prevent these ongoing failures?
GEM has submitted proposals to improve the recovery rate of the hot water system, as per Ormandy Rycroft's recommendations, which are awaiting approval.

7. How many people reported the problem, how many calls did you receive and how many repair references have you provided due to the hot water failure on the Curnock Street Estate between 23rd March 2024 and 04 March 2024?
Clarified:
The date range was approx. 15th February to 22nd February 2024
14.

Further Information:

We do not give our consent for any names and contact details provided in this response to be sent marketing material. Any such use will be reported to the ICO as a breach of General Data Protection Regulations and the Privacy and Electronic Communication Regulations.

Why not check our Portal Open Data Camden before making a new request as your question may already be answered by a previous FOI response or in one of our many useful and interesting datasets.

Your Rights

If you are not happy with how your response was handled you can request an Internal Review within 2 months of this letter by email to foireviews@camden.gov.uk or post: Information and Records Management Team, London Borough of Camden, Town Hall, Judd Street, London WC1H

9JE. Please quote your case reference number. If you are not satisfied with the Internal Review outcome you can complain to the Information Commissioner's Office at casework@ico.org.uk telephone 0303 123 1113, or post to Information Commissioner's Office, Wycliffe House, Water Lane, Wilmslow, Cheshire, SK9 5AF. The ICO website www.ico.org.uk may be useful.

Yours sincerely

Philip Lewis
Information Rights Officer